



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's talk about API!



Learning Outcome:

Identify key information about people's jobs and places of work in spoken or written contexts.
Make the information system design report, based on the selection of both hardware and software tools required for the IT solution.

Can Do Statements:

- I can explain what an API is.
- I can make comparisons among different interfaces related to software design.
- I can ask questions to obtain information related to API.

Ask your partner:

- Would you use a computer that can only do one thing at the time? Why? Why not?
- What programming interfaces do you know?





Let's Explore!

Today's class is about programming interfaces!



Instructions: Read the text below.

Mrs. Lawrence: Good morning class! Today we're going to talk about API. So, Joshua, how much do you know about it?

Joshua: Excuse me, Mrs. Lawrence, but I don't remember that topic.

Mrs. Lawrence: Don't worry! API refers to Application Program Interfaces. These applications let the computer systems interact with different programs, like in a multitasking process. For example, reading information stored in disk files, sending commands to the printer, or displaying diagrams and text lines on the monitor are cases in which we can appreciate API.

Joshua: Now, I remember, an API makes a program more functional since the programmer doesn't have to design everything because he can call upon a software library with different services ready to use.

Mrs. Lawrence: Exactly! That's known as an API call.

Joshua: Could you explain us more about that, please?

Mrs. Lawrence: Sure, an API call should consist in calling to a particular function, such as a dialog box. Then, the system answers with a pointer, known also as a handle, indicating that the application access is permitted, in this case the dialog box.

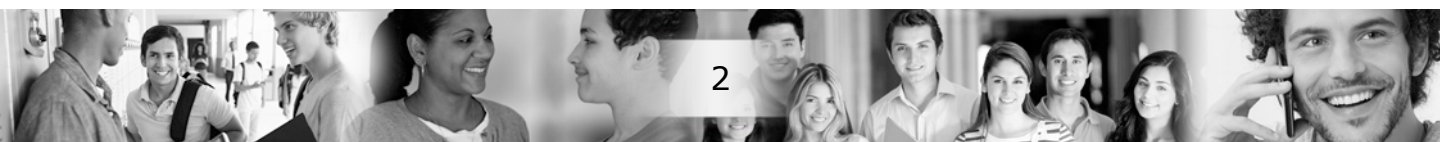
Joshua: What happens with higher operating systems like Windows?

Mrs. Lawrence: In that case, the API must count with a larger operating system. It is more sophisticated than other operating systems as it has to contain more functions, data and definitions.

Joshua: I see. That's why API for windows is more important than other applications.

Mrs. Lawrence: Yes! To finish, you must know that there are different interfaces related to software design. Some of them are MFC (Microsoft Foundation Classes) and Win32. Both are programming libraries; however, MFC is more functional than Win32 because it works with the programming language C++, which is an object-oriented language with generic features. On the contrary, Win32 works with the programming language C, which is a language with imperative features.

Joshua: So, we could say that MFC is more explicit than Win32.



**Let's Practice!**

Joshua is reading his notes.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing word in the blank. Use: don't have to, offers, go to.

An API is an Application Program Interface. It is a multitasking software library where the programmers _____ when they want to design a program. With this, they _____ create the functions of the program from zero because API _____ several commands that can they can use with a printer, a display or the text lines.

**Let's Practice!**

Joshua compares the two interfaces that he saw in class.

Instructions: Read the question. Select all the correct answers.

1. Which of the following statements is correct about MFC and Win 32 interfaces?
 - a. The MFC programming language is more practical than Win32 programming language.
 - b. MFC programming language is more sophisticated than Win32.
 - c. MFC is considered more practical because its codification is more generic than others are.
 - d. Win32 is more expensive than MFC.
 - e. Win32 uses programming language that allows to program in a more personalized way.





Extension Activity

Why is the API important in programming?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find someone who uses API for his/her job and ask about the importance of this resource.
- Write a descriptive text where you explain the importance of API.
- Share with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I find someone who uses API for his/her job and I ask about the importance of this resource.
- I write a descriptive text where I explain the importance of API.
- I share my writing with a partner.

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Target Words

- dialog box** (noun): a way to show information, to warn or to ask for permissions in a computer system
e.g. Sure, an API call should consist in calling to a particular function, such as a dialog box.
- generic** (adjective): a programming paradigm that consists in giving parameters based on algorithms to operate
e.g. However, MFC is more functional than Win32 because it works with the programming language C++, which is an object-oriented language with generic features.
- imperative** (noun): a programming paradigm that consists in giving commands to a program to operate
e.g. On the contrary, Win32 works with the programming language C, which is a language with imperative features.
- interact** (verb): to work with other parts at the same time and in a collaborative way
e.g. These applications let the computer systems interact with different programs, like in a multitasking process.
- disk file** (noun): a magnetic file containing data
e.g. For example, reading information stored in disk files, sending commands to the printer, or displaying diagrams and text lines on the monitor are cases in which we can appreciate API.
- call upon** (verb): to request something
e.g. The programmer doesn't have to design everything because he can call upon a software library with different services ready to use.



Learning Points

Comparatives to Talk About Tools for Web Design and Software Using More.

You use **comparatives** to show the differences between two or more objects, persons or **things**.

Long Adjectives

An adjective with more than two syllables is a **long adjective**.

(CHART 1)

To make comparisons with **long adjectives** you must use "more" before the adjective, and the conjunction "than" after the adjective. Check the structure that we use:

Subject + verb + **more** + adjective + **than** + complement.

Examples:

*This application is **more** interesting **than** its previous version.*

*Some programs can be **more** difficult to run **than** others.*

(CHART 1)

LONG ADJECTIVES 3- more syllables

- Interesting
- Difficult
- Important
- Expensive
- Intelligent
- Dangerous
- Sophisticated

Examples

- *That's why API for windows is more important than other applications.*
- *However, MFC is more functional than Win32 because it works with the programming language C++, which is an object-oriented language with generic features.*
- *So, we could say that MFC is more explicit than Win32.*



Learning Points

Useful Tech Terms.

The terminology that was once merely a part of the technology field is nowadays everywhere.

Here you can find some modern expressions related to technology; in fact, some of them are used in daily life contexts. And, others just make reference to essential computing terms.

MORE TECH TERMS	
1. Huge pipes	This is the informal expression to say that an Internet connection has a goodly bandwidth.
2. Mommy-save	Colloquial expression to indicate that someone clicks on the bottom "save" without knowing which folder to save in. Its particular name is due to moms which sometimes don't understand so much about technology and feel confused when performing a task in a computer.
3. Multitasking	When a computer can run many programs at the same time, it is considered to perform multitasking. This expression is also used in daily life when a person is able to do different activities at the same time. This evidences humans trying to be as computers.
4. Photoshopped	It comes from the word photoshop, which is a graphic program that lets you modify images. When something is photoshopped, it means that it was touched up before.
5. Plug-and-play	When a person buys a modern computer, he does not have to worry about drivers or installing programs as these computers are plug-and-play. That means that as soon as you plug in any additional device to the computer, it is ready to work.